

Tobias Treppmann

Design systems shaped by how the organization actually works

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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PORTFOLIO

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Design systems

DTCG design tokens · Style Dictionary · Storybook · Figma variables and live library sync · multi-platform token pipelines · component APIs and specifications · design systems built to stay intact under AI-assisted work · governance and contribution paths · motion carried as shared easing curves

Accessibility

EU Accessibility Act audits · WCAG contrast checked in code · screen-reader semantics and ARIA · alt text generated at platform scaleion across six countries

Building and tools

Prototyping in real code against production APIs · Android and Kotlin · SwiftUI · React and web · Claude Code and Zed as daily tools

Governance and strategy

Tools, governance and workflows · integrating new technology into how a team works · design strategy tied to business and product goals · change management across functions · mentoring designers outside a reporting line

PROFILE

Head of Product Design at Bibel TV, where the design system across iOS, Android, web and connected TV is mine — a token architecture in four tiers, built to serve all four platforms from one source. Nobody who builds with it reports to me. The work sits at external agencies and product managers set direction, so the system has to make the right path the fast one instead of relying on anyone’s review. I owned the design system at Ninox and defined component architecture at Datameer before that.

Enforced in the build

checks in CI refuse a token reference that does not resolve, or a color written straight into a component

Accessibility in code

WCAG contrast validated inside the color algorithm, and an EU Accessibility Act audit that covered the sites customers build

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- Won the agency over to a change that costs them billable work — type size, spacing and radius moved into the token API, so product teams adjust them without a ticket.
- Standardization and flexibility, without trading one for the other — component and view tiers alias down to the primitives and add no new values, so a team moves without the foundation moving.
- Built for the people who are not designers — Storybook as the shared surface, and the token vocabulary handed to an AI assistant as a closed list rather than recalled.
- The build is the reviewer — CI rejects a token reference that does not resolve and a color written in by hand. Neither shows up as a visual difference.
- Accessibility computed rather than checked — a color engine builds themes from program artwork with WCAG contrast validated inside the algorithm, so a failing theme cannot ship.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Made an accessibility law survivable for the customers it landed on — churches run their websites on our platform, and the European Accessibility Act gave them a legal deadline.
- Shipped the capability that let them meet it automatically — six countries, under GDPR plus church data-protection law. The audit covered every site customers build with the platform.
- Built booking into the platform instead of bolting it on — the same build then carried room rentals, baptisms and weddings. 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance, then shipped to every customer.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Owned the design system, and built the governance around it — a standing working group with engineering and four designers, with an escalation path, so decisions held after I left the room.
- Ran design and product at the same time — for four months, nine people across design, UX writing, product management and data science, on the senior leadership team. Hired two, promoted two.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Turned a services business into a product catalog — with the executive team of a listed group, and ran the design-thinking training for leadership.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Defined how components behaved — what each one did, what it guaranteed and where it could be used, across the design system library.
- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years, setting the design bar across both sites.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade mentoring and coaching designers

Mentor · *Interaction Design Foundation* · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people

Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA